

Late Blight



⚠ **Note :** Our AI helps quickly identify plant diseases, but it isn't 100% accurate. Results depend heavily on image quality—blurry photos can confuse the model. Always verify the final diagnosis with a qualified plant expert..

About disease and the symptoms

Late blight is caused by a water mold (or fungus-like organism) called *Phytophthora infestans*. It thrives in cool, wet, and rainy weather—basically the exact opposite of what normal fungi love.

The spores travel easily on the wind for miles or hitch a ride on infected starter plants. Once they land on a wet leaf, they aggressively attack the plant's cells, turning healthy foliage into a soggy, ruined mess in no time.

Late blight looks quite different from other leaf spots, making it easier to identify once it strikes. Here is what to watch out for:

Water-Soaked Spots: It usually begins as large, irregular, pale green or water-soaked spots on the edges or tips of the leaves.

Rapid Browning: These pale spots quickly turn dark brown or purplish-black, spreading across the leaf tissue very rapidly.

Fuzzy White Growth: If the humidity is high or there is heavy morning dew, you will often see a distinct white, fuzzy mold growing on the undersides of the leaves directly beneath the dark spots.

Stem Lesions: It doesn't just stick to the leaves! You'll frequently see dark, blackened, greasy-looking patches spreading down the plant's main stems.

Treatment

Unfortunately, late blight is so aggressive that there is no real cure once a plant is infected, so treatment is really all about rapid damage control! The safest thing you can do to protect your other plants (and your neighbors' gardens) is to immediately pull up and destroy the infected plants—put them straight into a sealed garbage bag, never your compost bin, so the spores cannot spread. If you have completely healthy plants nearby, you can proactively spray them with a copper-based fungicide to act as a protective shield against the spores that travel on the wind. Going forward, keeping your plant leaves perfectly dry by watering at the base and choosing disease-resistant varieties for next season will be your absolute best defense against this fast-moving disease.

